

# About Us

**Since 1978** VMA GROUP has focused on building strong and lasting relationships in the communications, marketing, digital and more recently, change sectors.

VMA GROUP offers a range of recruitment services on an international basis covering executive search, permanent, contract and interim.

With offices across the UK and Europe, we have a reputation for being a leader in our field, supported by in-depth knowledge of the professions we recruit for.

Our team, which includes industry specialists, maintain long-term relationships with our international network of clients, from innovative, independent start-ups, to large complex multinational corporations, as well as public sector and not-for-profit organisations.

VMA GROUP is a member of APSCo, the professional body representing excellence in the recruitment sector. Having completed APSCo Inclusive+ training, our recruitment consultants strive to help our clients ensure they create a working environment where people from all backgrounds can thrive.

In addition to our recruitment services, VMA GROUP also offers a range of advisory services, focused on talent management including organisation design, executive coaching and ED&I consulting.

VMA GROUP has a strong track record of producing industry-leading research. Our thought leadership and bench-marking studies have become go-to resources for our international network, supporting organisational planning and decision-making.

We also host a wide variety of events, including advisory boards, roundtables and webinars. These events facilitate an opportunity for industry professionals to network, develop new ideas and stay up-to-date with the latest industry news.

# VMA GROUP

RECRUITMENT • EXECUTIVE SEARCH • ADVISORY SERVICES

# Communications

**VMA GROUP** has supported the corporate affairs and communications industry since 1978.

The conversations we have with corporate affairs and communications leaders, whether they are looking to fill gaps, build or restructure their teams, or are looking to advance within their own career path, provide us with great insight into the latest developments in the profession and the challenges communicators face in their roles.

*Our experienced, specialist consultants operate across the breadth of the corporate affairs function and place communications professionals within all sectors, including:*



*External Communications, Internal Communications, Public Affairs, Investor Relations, Financial PR, Consumer PR, Strategic Communications, Executive Communications & Stakeholder Relations*

Working across the UK and internationally, we can support your organisation with permanent, interim and contract recruitment, as well as executive search for corporate affairs and communications leaders.



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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Director of Communications<br><b>The British Museum,</b><br>London                         | Head of Public Affairs<br><b>American Express,</b><br>Singapore    | Group Communications Director<br><b>Unite Students,</b><br>Bristol             |
| Internal Communications Channel Executive<br><b>British Transport Police</b><br>Manchester | PR Manager<br><b>CISCO,</b><br>The Netherlands                     | Global Head of Corporate Communications<br><b>Allen &amp; Overy,</b><br>London |
| Employee Communications Executive<br><b>Thames Water,</b><br>Reading                       | Integration Communications Manager<br><b>Rathbones,</b><br>London  | Head of Communications<br><b>CFE Group,</b><br>Belgium                         |
| Senior Spokesperson & Communications Advisor<br><b>Tata Steel,</b><br>The Netherlands      | External Affairs Manager<br><b>United Utilities,</b><br>Manchester | Internal Communications Partner<br><b>Entain,</b><br>London                    |

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“I really appreciated the way **VMA GROUP** took our brief, didn’t blink when we unilaterally expanded it, worked with the team and persisted with our processes to get not just one, but two candidates through the door. We’ve made a point of sharing our positive experience with the wider corporate affairs team here and I hope that they too will benefit from working with **VMA GROUP** in the future as and when opportunities arise.”

*Group Public Affairs Director,  
**Lloyds Banking Group***

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For more information please contact  
**Lucy Cairncross, Managing Director:**

✉ [lcairncross@vmagroup.com](mailto:lcairncross@vmagroup.com)

☎ +44(0)2033 277623



# Marketing & Digital

At **VMA GROUP** we understand how important it is to have the right skills and experience in your marketing and digital teams, especially as the industry continues to change at pace.

We manage a broad network of highly accomplished marketing and digital professionals from across the full marketing and digital mix, so irrespective of your bespoke talent needs, we always have suitably qualified marketeers and digital talent ready to join your team.

*We partner with organisations to establish and grow their marketing teams in areas including:*

 Strategic Marketing, Digital Marketing, Social Media, Branding, E-Commerce, Email Marketing, Graphic Design, Influencer Marketing, Events, Content, Campaigns, Search Engine Optimisation (SEO), Bids, Analysis, Pay-Per-Click (PPC), Market Research, User Experience (UX)

|                                                                                          |                                                                  |                                                     |                                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Director of Marketing & Communications<br><b>ABRSM,</b><br>London                        | Head of Digital Marketing<br><b>Roland Berger,</b><br>Germany    | Marketing Executive<br><b>OpenDialog,</b><br>London | Marketing Executive<br><b>Lloyds Bank,</b><br>Bristol                      |
| Director of Marketing & Communications<br><b>National Football Museum,</b><br>Manchester | PPC Specialist<br><b>Great Ormond Street Hospital,</b><br>London | SEO Editor<br><b>Staysure,</b><br>Northampton       | Head of Brand<br><b>Institute &amp; Faculty of Actuaries,</b><br>Edinburgh |
| Marketing & Communications Officer<br><b>Ravo Fayat,</b><br>The Netherlands              | Social Media Specialist<br><b>Padra Clinic,</b><br>Canada        | Content Manager<br><b>Lyreco,</b><br>Belgium        | Associate, Investment Content Marketing<br><b>BlackRock,</b><br>London     |



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“I was initially recommended to give **VMA GROUP** a call from a CMO I had worked with previously, sharing the positive experiences she had working with them. They understood our brief, identified a number of suitable candidates and continually communicated throughout the process. They listened well and had a great knowledge of marketing practices. We were provided with exceptional candidates in the process and made the fantastic decision to appoint the successful candidate. We are and will continue to work with **VMA GROUP** as our team grows.”

Founder,  
**OpenDialog**

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For more information please contact  
**Andrew Harvey, Chief Executive:**

 [aharvey@vmagroup.com](mailto:aharvey@vmagroup.com)

 +44(0)7500 445800



# Change Management

In 2023 we introduced our Change Management practice to **VMA GROUP**.

In recent years, the volume and scale of change within organisations has caused a considerable increase in the need for change professionals.

Transformation is complex, multi-faceted and impacts all areas of an organisation. Employing someone with the right skills and experience to support organisational change is vital to ensure its long-term success.

*Change appointments we recruit for include:*



*Project Manager, Business Analyst, Scrum Master, Change & Culture Lead, Programme Director, Head of Change Communications, Data Manager, Project Support*

An interim approach can be especially effective when it comes to change management. Interim change managers are experienced professionals who are well-equipped to handle complex projects with critical deadlines and therefore provide a helpful solution when you need temporary support.

**VMA GROUP** maintains a vast network of highly talented interim, contract and permanent change specialists. Available at short notice and on an international basis, we are ready to support you, whenever and wherever change is taking place.

For more information please contact  
**Matt Gibbs, Head of Interim & Contract:**

✉ [mgibbs@vmagroup.com](mailto:mgibbs@vmagroup.com)

☎ +44(0)7917 385062



*"For 45 years **VMA GROUP** has been a leader for recruitment in the communications, marketing and digital sectors. In 2023, as a natural continuation of our existing business specialisms and due to rising demand for change professionals, we introduced a change management practice to **VMA GROUP**.*

*We recognise that the most successful organisations continue to change and evolve. Employing change management professionals to support with business transformation is a crucial step to improve the likelihood of success and bring longevity to the impacts of the change."*

*Andrew Harvey, Chief Executive Officer,  
**VMA GROUP***



# Executive Search

With a proven track record in executive search, **VMA GROUP** partners with organisations around the world. We have a rich heritage in sourcing communications, marketing, digital and change talent and offer tailored searches to support our clients with local, regional and global talent requirements.

In our holistic approach to search and selection, we regularly work with organisations before they have a clear role defined. We offer support on market benchmarking, role definition and internal candidate assessments alongside team reorganisation.

“

**VMA GROUP** were an excellent team and delivered in every way that I would expect a search firm to do and with a very personable and natural approach. It was a pleasure to work with them and I wouldn't hesitate to recommend them to others.

HR Director  
**Boehringer Ingelheim**

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Group Head of Communications<br><b>Immobel,</b><br>Belgium        | Group Head of Press Relations<br><b>Imerys,</b><br>France              | Chief Marketing Officer,<br><b>Synechron,</b><br>UK                     |
| Global Head of Communications & Change<br><b>Capgemini,</b><br>UK | Chief Executive Officer<br><b>Euro Media Group,</b><br>The Netherlands | Head of Group Public Affairs<br><b>Manchester Airports Group,</b><br>UK |
| Head of Corporate Communications Lead<br><b>Centrica,</b><br>UK   | Head of Digital<br><b>Accor,</b><br>Germany                            | Head of Communications<br><b>P&amp;O Ferries,</b><br>UK                 |

# Interim & Contract

**VMA GROUP** has an extensive portfolio of highly talented interim managers across all disciplines. Our contract team work to a 48-hour turnaround on CV shortlists to make sure you have the best candidates in the quickest time.

### Key Benefits of Hiring Interim & Contract Professionals:

- Extra support for an under-resourced team
- Part of the team, but no impact on 'permanent' headcount numbers
- Strategic and delivery focused
- Contracts are flexible, with shorter notice periods and are easy to extend or terminate
- Able to provide an independent external view

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Communications Manager<br><b>Teknos,</b><br>Finland               | Communications Lead<br><b>Norse Group,</b><br>Norwich                      | Digital Marketing Specialist<br><b>Imperial Brands,</b><br>Bristol |
| Internal Communications Consultant<br><b>Coca Cola,</b><br>London | Internal Communications Consultant<br><b>Vision Express,</b><br>Nottingham | Internal Communications Manager<br><b>IKEA,</b><br>The Netherlands |
| Change Communications Lead<br><b>Chromalox,</b><br>Croydon        | Marketing Manager<br><b>BlackRock,</b><br>Belgium                          | Head of Internal Communications<br><b>Deloitte,</b><br>London      |



# Our International Reach

VMA GROUP has supported clients in

over  
**20**  
countries

VMA GROUP truly is an international business. Despite our offices being based across the UK and Europe, we have supported a diverse network of clients in **over 20 countries** and candidates from all across the world.

For 45 years, we have been building our international talent pool. Having a such a broad network of candidates ensures we are well placed to fulfil our client's talent needs, irrespective of location.

For more information please contact **Willem de Ruijter, Executive Director, Europe:**

✉ [wderuijter@vmagroup.com](mailto:wderuijter@vmagroup.com)

☎ +31 (0)2080 83990



# Advisory Services

VMA GROUP's Advisory Services have been developed in response to the changing talent needs of organisations. Utilising our own in-house specialists and a network of industry experts, we offer organisations a number of additional talent services, tailored to their individual requirements.

## Organisation Design

VMA GROUP has developed a successful methodology to support organisations in the management and delivery of a wide variety of organisation design projects, to improve the efficiency of their communications, marketing, digital and change functions.

## Executive Coaching & Professional Development

Executive coaching and professional development can help empower leaders and future leaders to be the best they can be. Whether a member of your team is struggling to manage demanding stakeholders, or perhaps you want to build your own self-confidence and strategic abilities, executive coaching can help everyone achieve more.

## Equity, Diversity & Inclusion Consulting

VMA GROUP partner with specialist associates to assess ED&I through the lens of your organisation. By targeting systemic barriers and focusing on driving a greater sense of inclusion for all, we work to develop and embed an ED&I strategy that creates progression in your organisation.

For more information please contact *Lucy Cairncross, Managing Director:*

✉ [lcairncross@vmagroup.com](mailto:lcairncross@vmagroup.com)

☎ +44(0)2033 277623

# Insight & Events

## Industry Insight

VMA GROUP has a strong heritage in conducting industry research for the professions we support. Our conversations with industry professionals and business leaders give us unparalleled insight into current trends and developments in your industry. These reports have become an invaluable resource in assisting planning and decision-making.

VMA GROUP's leading industry reports include:

- *Inside Insight*
- *The View*
- *Changing Communications*



## Industry-Leading Events

We maintain a varied calendar of industry-leading events including advisory boards, roundtables, webinars and networking sessions.

Focusing on topical issues and trends in the communications, marketing, digital and change sectors, these events foster an environment for professionals to discuss industry challenges, opportunities and share best practice.



# Contact Us

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**VMA**  
GROUP

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